

ZScape3 Setup Guide

Docker-based installation and usage instructions

Overview

This guide explains how to set up and use the ZScape3 website on a Windows computer using Docker Desktop and terminal commands.

The process is simple and does not require programming knowledge.

1. How to Setup the Website

Before choosing a method below, make sure you complete this mandatory prerequisite:

- **Install Docker Desktop:** Download and install Docker Desktop from <https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop/>. After installation, launch Docker Desktop and wait until the status panel shows **Engine Running**.

Method 1: Manual Configuration from Scratch

Follow these steps if you want to set up the setup environment directory structure and configuration files manually:

1. **Create the project folder.** Create a folder named `zscrape3` anywhere on your computer.
2. **Open Terminal inside the folder.** Open the `zscrape3` folder and launch **Terminal** from that location.
3. **Create the required folders.** Run the following commands in Terminal:

```
mkdir backend
mkdir backend\downloads
```

4. **Create docker-compose.yml.** Run the following command exactly:

```
@"
services:
  backend:
    image: mdk7866/zscrape3-backend:latest
    container_name: zscrape3-backend
    ports:
      - "8000:8000"
    volumes:
      - ./backend/downloads:/app/downloads
    env_file:
      - ./backend/.env
    restart: always

  frontend:
    image: mdk7866/zscrape3-frontend:latest
    container_name: zscrape3-frontend
    ports:
      - "3000:3000"
    environment:
      - NEXT_PUBLIC_API_URL=http://localhost:8000
    depends_on:
      - backend
    restart: always

networks:
  default:
```

```
name: zscrape3-network
"@ | Set-Content docker-compose.yml
```

5. **Create the .env file.** Run the following command exactly:

```
@"
DATABASE_NAME=mpca2
CHATGPT_PAID_API_KEY=sk-proj-
CJX2Jy9FHMofB0PiuMPUC1Fr1qXa0FSIgdrcfuZau7rUWu5Fs7YIPArub2UANBCjVdRZ2emRnxT3B1bkFJyFuPUwa9INYPeJwBAeEKYzeCQSLFgA7G
-ixs_S4_EGOC5rK2xBsN-yycdlUx-yGM8JXmil0VIA
SUPABASE_URL=https://pljhwcmguyogknvrgmdo.supabase.co
SUPABASE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY=sb_publishable_KUeHK6GSHVGrijdddpACQ_enVXVGE8
SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY=sb_secret_-F40-WqbUrPOiWQcWIlvew_3FbgFf0P
"@ | Set-Content backend/.env
```

6. **Start the website.** Run the following command to spin up the local server containers:

```
docker-compose up -d
```

The first-time setup may take 15–20 minutes on your PC. After that, the website usually starts within a few seconds.

7. **Verify that the containers are running.** Run:

```
docker ps
```

Method 2: Pre-configured Zip Folder Setup

Follow these simpler steps if you already have the pre-built **zscrape3** zip folder deployment package:

1. **Unzip the project package.** Locate the zip file on your machine and extract its entire contents.
2. **Open the extracted project folder.** Navigate directly into the newly extracted folder named **zscrape3** (where you see files like **docker-compose.yml** and the **backend** directory.)
3. **Open Terminal from this directory.** Launch **Terminal**, **Command Prompt**, or **Power-Shell** directly within the root of this **zscrape3** directory.
4. **Launch Docker services directly.** Because your environment and compose configuration files are already set up inside this folder, you can immediately execute your deployment containers:

```
docker-compose up -d
```

5. **Verify running state.** Check that your containers successfully deployed in the background background loop:

```
docker ps
```

You should see both **zscrape3-backend** and **zscrape3-frontend** containers up and running.

2. How to Use the Website

1. **Open the website in your browser.** After the containers are running, visit:

```
http://localhost:3000/
```

The website will appear as shown below.

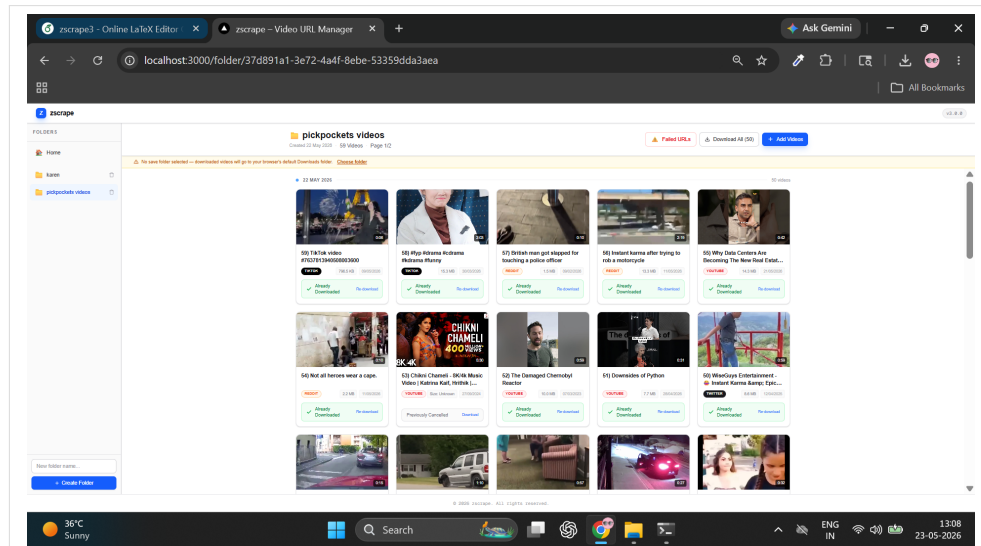


Figure 1: ZScape3 website running at localhost:3000

2. **Supported video platforms.** The website works smoothly for downloading videos from **Instagram, Reddit, Twitter/X, YouTube, and Facebook** without any additional configuration.
3. **TikTok downloads require Proton VPN Desktop.** Since TikTok is restricted in India, you must use the **Proton VPN Desktop App** before downloading TikTok videos.

Download the desktop application here:

<https://protonvpn.com/download>

After installation, connect the VPN to a suitable server and then start the TikTok download process.

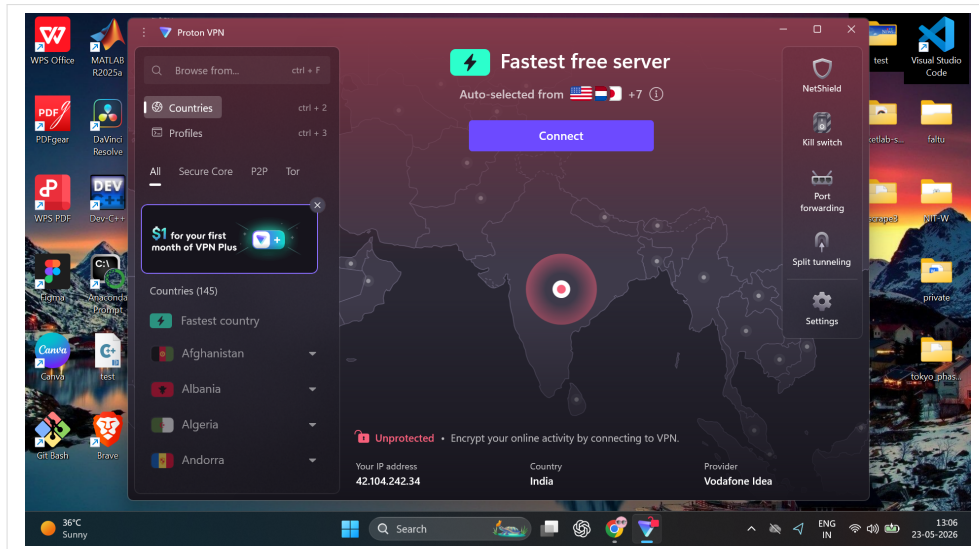


Figure 2: Proton VPN Desktop App connected to a server

Important Note for TikTok

For TikTok downloads, keep Proton VPN enabled only while downloading TikTok content. If the VPN is not used when required, the download speed may become slow or unstable.

4. **Stop the website after use.** Once you finish using the website, return to the same terminal and run:

```
docker-compose down
```

This will stop the website safely.

3. Quick Start Summary

For regular use, the workflow is simple:

1. Open Terminal inside the **zscape3** folder.
2. Run **docker-compose up -d**
3. Open **http://localhost:3000/**
4. After finishing your work, run **docker-compose down**

4. Update Website to Latest Version

Whenever a new version of the website is released, run the following commands inside the **zscape3** folder:

```
docker-compose down
docker-compose pull
docker-compose up -d
```

This will:

- Stop the old containers
- Download the latest version from Docker Hub
- Start the updated website automatically

Troubleshooting Note

Sometimes, after a long period of inactivity, the command:

```
docker-compose up -d
```

may not work properly if Docker Desktop is not running in the background.

In that case:

1. Open Docker Desktop manually.
2. Wait until Docker shows **Engine Running**.
3. Run the command again:

```
docker-compose up -d
```

After Docker Desktop starts successfully, the website should work normally.